

Locust Grove Nature Center

Maryland-National Capital Park and Planning Commission
7777 Democracy Boulevard, Bethesda MD



April 14, 2025

To Whom it May Concern:

I am writing to express my full support and appreciation for Eagle Scout candidate Kyle Chen, who completed his project at Locust Grove Nature Center on November 23, 2024. Kyle's project was to design and build two archways that now serve as the entrances to our "Path to the Past" and "Habitat Hike" trails.

The goal of this project was to draw visitor attention to these trails in a way that was welcoming, visually striking, and still in keeping with the natural setting of our park. Kyle accomplished this beautifully. The archways he built are colorful and eye-catching without being out of place—they manage to be both playful and elegant, featuring subtle embellishments that give them a polished, handcrafted feel while remaining rustic and appropriate for a woodland environment.

One of the qualities that stood out most during this project was Kyle's professionalism and adaptability. He was extremely easy to work with and approached every part of the process with a positive, collaborative attitude. When unexpected challenges arose—including one that was due to a mistake on my end—Kyle handled the situation with maturity, flexibility, and grace. He made smart adjustments to his plans and kept the project moving forward without missing a beat.

Thanks to Kyle's excellent craftsmanship and thoughtful leadership, these new archways have enhanced the park in both form and function. We are so grateful for the care and creativity he brought to this project, and thank him for donating the materials.

Sincerely,
Jacqueline Raiford

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Jacqueline Raiford".

Principal Park Naturalist
Montgomery Parks